1.6.2 Professional Organizations

Organizations provide a means through which united efforts are made to elevate standards of nursing education and practice. It also offers a means of voicing and opinions, developing our abilities and keeping informed of new trends.

A. World Health Organization (WHO)

The world Health Organization is a specialized agency of the United Nations. It was organized in 1948 to achieve the highest possible level of health for all people. The WHO is also active in nursing education and practice in a number of ways in India:

B. The International Council of Nurses (ICN)

The International Council of Nurses was founded in 1899 by Mrs. Bedford Fenwick.

Objectives

1. It provides uniform standards in nursing education and reciprocity in nursing registration.
2. It has authority to prescribe curriculum for nursing education in all states.
3. It has authority to recognise programme of nursing education or to refuse recognition of a programme if it did not meet the standards required by the council.
4. It is registering the foreign nurses.
5. It also maintains the Indian Nurses Register.
6. The INC authorises State Nurses Registration Council and examining board to issue qualifying certificates.

C. The Indian Nursing Council (INC)

The Indian Nursing Council was authorized by the Indian Nursing Council Act of 1947. It was established in 1949 to provide uniform standards in nursing education and reciprocity in nursing registration throughout the country.

Objectives of ICN

1. To promote the development of the strong national nurses association.
2. To assist national nurses association to improve the standards of nursing education and practice.
3. To assist national nurses association to improve the status of nurses within their countries.
4. To serve as the authoritative voice for nurses and nursing internationally.

D. TamilNadu Nurses and Mid-Wives council

Every professional nurses in the nursing professions, either here or abroad must be registered with the one of the state Nurses Registration Councils. The state council functions as an official to control the standards of the nursing practice



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